

POLICY CLARIFICATION REQUEST

AI-assisted processing of Google Business Profile reviews

A proposed data flow for review classification, manager-requested reply drafts, and property-level theme reporting.

SUBMITTED BY Reputation Key (RepKey)	DATE 14 July 2026	STATUS Proposed - not in production
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Decision requested

Please confirm whether the proposed uses are permitted and identify any required retention, deletion, consent, provider, or processing-location conditions.

Purpose and customer authorization

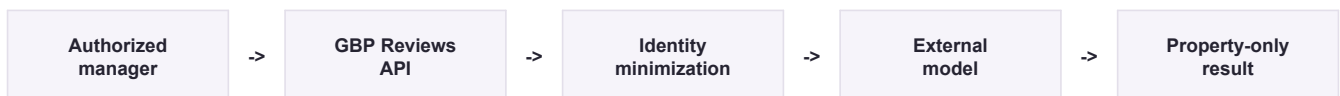
Reputation Key is a review-management service for hotels and other multi-location businesses. A manager connects a Google Business Profile account through Google OAuth. RepKey retrieves reviews only for locations the customer owns or is authorized to manage, and results remain visible only to authorized users of that property.

Before implementation, we are asking how the Business Profile API content-storage and automated-use policies apply - especially the restriction on manipulating or aggregating API content, the 30-day limit, and external model processing.

Proposed functionality

1. Review analysis A minimized review payload is classified for sentiment and service category. RepKey calculates priority from rating, sentiment, and review age.	2. Reply drafting A manager requests and edits a draft, then uses a separate Publish action. Nothing is generated and posted automatically.
3. Property themes Up to 100 recent reviews from one property are analyzed for themes, trajectories, and a short summary. Properties are never combined.	4. Historical pass A newly connected property may opt into a one-time classification of existing reviews. The content is not used for model training or fine-tuning.

Proposed data flow



The model provider has not been selected. Options under consideration include the OpenAI API, Azure OpenAI, and models available through AWS Bedrock. Provider selection depends in part on Google's guidance.

PROPOSED SAFEGUARDS AND QUESTIONS

Data handling proposed by RepKey

These controls are design commitments for the proposed features. Final retention and regional settings will follow Google's response and the selected provider contract.

Data sent	Review text, star rating, review date, language, and limited property context.
Data excluded	Reviewer name, profile URL, profile photo, and unrelated reviewer metadata.
Provider controls	No model training on customer content; shortest available retention; regional processing where required.
User control	Customer AI opt-in; editable drafts; separate Publish action; AI can be disabled.
Operational controls	No prompt bodies in ordinary logs; metadata-only audit trail; AI failures do not block non-AI features.

Points requiring clarification

1. May minimized review content be sent to a contracted external language-model provider for sentiment classification, categorization, priority scoring support, and reply drafting?
2. Is creating or retaining sentiment labels, categories, and priority scores considered prohibited manipulation of Business Profile API content?
3. Is identifying themes and producing a summary from reviews belonging to one property considered prohibited aggregation when properties are never combined?
4. Does the 30-day storage limit apply only to review content returned by the API, or also to derived labels, scores, themes, trajectories, and summaries?
5. If derived results are permitted, may they remain after the underlying API content is refreshed or deleted? What must be deleted when a customer disconnects?
6. Is an optional one-time analysis of existing reviews allowed, or would it be treated as prohibited pre-fetching, caching, or indexing?
7. May up to three replies previously published by the same property be used as style examples for a new reply draft?
8. For analysis, are OAuth authorization and a clear customer AI opt-in sufficient? For replies, do separate Generate draft and Publish reply actions satisfy prior specific and express consent?
9. Are there additional requirements for the model provider, processing location, retention, data-processing agreement, or subprocessors?

Requested response	Written confirmation for each point, including any conditions required for compliance. If policy interpretation is needed, please refer the case to the Google Business Profile API policy team.
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References

1. [Google Business Profile API policies](#)
2. [Google API Services User Data Policy](#)
3. [Google APIs Terms of Service](#)

Google Cloud project number: supplied in the associated private support case. No credentials, customer names, or real review content are included in this document.